



Mavilo Pet Co.

HAPPY PETS, PRACTICAL CARE

PRINTABLE GUIDE



EVERYTHING FOR THE FIRST 30 DAYS

New Pet Starter Checklist Kit

For dogs & cats. Plan, shop, pet-proof and settle in with confidence — with printable checklists and worksheets for every step.



WHAT'S INSIDE

- Pre-adoption questions
- Dog & cat shopping lists
- Room-by-room pet-proofing
- First 24 hours, week & month
- First vet visit questions
- Budget planner worksheet
- Emergency contacts sheet
- Printable, fill-in pages

Dogs + Cats

Checklists for both

9

Printable worksheets

30 days

Settling-in roadmap



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HOW TO USE THIS PDF

Read it on screen or print the whole thing. Worksheet pages are designed to be printed again and again, so feel free to print extra copies of any tracker you use often. Tip: print at “Actual size” on US Letter paper.

Welcome Home!

Bringing home a new dog or cat is one of life's great joys — and a big responsibility. This kit helps you get it right.

Whether you're adopting from a shelter, welcoming a rescue or bringing home a puppy or kitten from a breeder, the first few weeks set the tone for your life together. A little planning means fewer surprises, a calmer pet, and a happier household.

How to use this kit

- 1 Before you commit:** Work through the *Pre-Adoption Questions* as a household. Honest answers now prevent heartbreak later.
- 2 Two weeks before arrival:** Use the *Shopping Checklist* for your species and the *Budget Planner*. Book a vet appointment for the first week.
- 3 A few days before:** Walk through your home with the *Pet-Proofing Checklist*. Set up a quiet "home base" room.
- 4 Arrival day and beyond:** Follow the *First 24 Hours*, *First Week & First Month* plan.
- 5 Keep it handy:** Fill in the *Emergency Contacts Sheet* and post it on the fridge. Bring the *Vet Visit Questions* to your first appointment.

THE 3-3-3 GUIDELINE

Many rescues describe adjustment as roughly **3 days** to decompress, **3 weeks** to learn your routine, and **3 months** to feel truly at home. Every pet is different — patience is the most important thing you can bring.

DOGS VS. CATS

Look for the **DOG** and **CAT** tags throughout. Items with no tag apply to both. Cats often need a smaller space and more time to explore; dogs need structure, potty trips and gentle introductions.

Important: This guide is general education, not veterinary advice; consult your veterinarian about your own pet's health, diet, medications, and any symptoms that concern you.

Pre-Adoption Questions

Talk these through together. There are no wrong answers — only honest ones.

Question	Yes	No	Not sure	Notes / plan
Does everyone in the household want a pet and agree on the type?	☐	☐	☐	
Does anyone have pet allergies? (Spend time with the species first.)	☐	☐	☐	
Does our lease or HOA allow this pet (species, size, breed, number)?	☐	☐	☐	
Who will feed, walk, clean up and handle vet visits?	☐	☐	☐	
How many hours a day will the pet be home alone?	☐	☐	☐	
Do our energy level and schedule match this pet's exercise needs?	☐	☐	☐	
Are we ready for 10–20 years of care?	☐	☐	☐	
Can we afford routine care <i>and</i> a surprise vet bill?	☐	☐	☐	
Do we have a plan for travel (pet sitter, boarding, pet-friendly trips)?	☐	☐	☐	
How will current pets and children be introduced safely?	☐	☐	☐	
Puppy/kitten, adult or senior — which fits our life best?	☐	☐	☐	
Are we prepared for training, scratching, shedding or accidents?	☐	☐	☐	

Questions to ask the shelter, rescue or breeder

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ How old is the pet? Any known history? | ☐ What food are they eating now? (Keep it the same at first.) |
| ☐ What is their personality and energy level? | ☐ Are they house-trained / litter-trained? |
| ☐ How do they do with kids, dogs and cats? | ☐ Any fears, triggers or behavior concerns? |
| ☐ Any medical conditions or medications? | ☐ Can I get copies of all medical records? |
| ☐ Vaccinations, spay/neuter and microchip status? | ☐ What is the return or support policy? |

Dog Shopping Checklist DOG

Start with the essentials. You can add fun extras once you know your dog's preferences.

Essentials

- ☐ Food (same brand the shelter/breeder used, to start)
- ☐ Food and water bowls (stainless steel or ceramic)
- ☐ Collar or harness that fits (two fingers under the strap)
- ☐ ID tag with your phone number
- ☐ 6-ft leash
- ☐ Poop bags + holder
- ☐ Enzymatic stain & odor cleaner

Rest & safety

- ☐ Crate sized for adult size (with divider for puppies)
- ☐ Washable bed or crate pad
- ☐ Baby gates or exercise pen
- ☐ Car restraint: crash-tested harness or secured crate
- ☐ Night-time light-up collar or clip light

Training & enrichment

- ☐ Small soft training treats
- ☐ Treat pouch
- ☐ Food-stuffable rubber toy
- ☐ Chew toys sized for your dog
- ☐ Tug toy and a ball
- ☐ Snuffle mat or puzzle feeder
- ☐ Long line (15–30 ft) for recall practice

Grooming & care

- ☐ Brush or comb suited to coat type
- ☐ Dog shampoo (never human shampoo)
- ☐ Nail clippers or grinder + styptic powder
- ☐ Dog toothbrush + dog toothpaste
- ☐ Towels and paw-wipe cloth
- ☐ Poop scooper for the yard

SKIP FOR NOW

Retractable leashes, choke/prong/shock collars, rawhide for strong chewers (choking risk), and very hard chews like antlers or bones that can fracture teeth. Ask your vet about safe chew options.

My extras

Cat Shopping Checklist CAT

Cats love predictable resources in quiet places. Plan where each item will go before your cat arrives.

Essentials

- ☐ Food (same brand the shelter/breeder used, to start)
- ☐ Shallow food and water bowls (many cats prefer wide dishes)
- ☐ Water fountain (optional, encourages drinking)
- ☐ Breakaway collar + ID tag
- ☐ Sturdy carrier with top and front opening
- ☐ Enzymatic stain & odor cleaner

Litter setup

- ☐ Litter boxes: one per cat **plus one**
- ☐ Large, uncovered boxes about 1.5× your cat's body length
- ☐ Unscented clumping litter
- ☐ Litter scoop + bags or lidded bin
- ☐ Litter mat to catch scatter

Scratching & climbing

- ☐ Tall, sturdy vertical scratching post (can stretch fully)
- ☐ Horizontal cardboard scratcher
- ☐ Cat tree or wall shelves near a window
- ☐ Hiding spots: cat cave or covered bed
- ☐ Window perch

Play & grooming

- ☐ Wand/feather toy (put away after play)
- ☐ Small balls, crinkle toys, kicker toys
- ☐ Puzzle feeder or treat ball
- ☐ Brush or comb for coat type
- ☐ Cat nail clippers + styptic powder
- ☐ Cat toothbrush + pet toothpaste

CAT SAFETY NOTE

Avoid string, yarn, ribbon, hair ties and rubber bands as unsupervised toys — if swallowed, they can cause serious intestinal injury. Keep lilies out of any home with a cat: all parts of true lilies (*Lilium*) and daylilies (*Heemerocallis*), including pollen and vase water, can cause kidney failure.

My extras

Home Pet-Proofing, Room by Room

Get down to your pet's eye level. If it's chewable, swallowable or climbable, it will be explored.

Kitchen

- ☐ Trash can with locking lid or inside a cabinet
- ☐ Child locks on cabinets with cleaners
- ☐ Keep toxic foods out of reach: chocolate, grapes/raisins, onions, garlic, xylitol (sugar-free gum, some peanut butters), macadamia nuts, alcohol, caffeine
- ☐ Stove knob covers (cats and counter-surfing dogs)
- ☐ Knives, foil and plastic wrap put away

Living room

- ☐ Cords tucked away or covered
- ☐ Blind and curtain cords tied up out of reach
- ☐ Toxic plants removed (check the ASPCA plant list)
- ☐ Small items off the floor: coins, batteries, hair ties, toys
- ☐ Fragile décor moved off low tables and shelves

Bathroom

- ☐ Toilet lid down (drowning risk for small pets; chemicals)
- ☐ Medications in a closed cabinet — never on counters
- ☐ Razors, floss and cotton swabs in lidded bins
- ☐ Essential oils stored away; avoid diffusers around cats

Bedrooms

- ☐ Laundry, socks and underwear in hampers with lids
- ☐ Chargers and earbuds off the floor
- ☐ Check under beds and closets for small hiding hazards
- ☐ Jewelry and hair ties in closed boxes

Garage & yard

- ☐ Antifreeze, pesticides, rodent and snail bait locked away
- ☐ Fence checked for gaps and digging spots
- ☐ Pool/hot tub fenced or covered
- ☐ Sharp tools and fertilizer stored up high
- ☐ Gates latched; check that pets can't squeeze through

Whole home

- ☐ Window screens secure (cats can fall from open windows)
- ☐ Recliners and washers/dryers checked before use
- ☐ Doors and exits: plan to prevent dashing out
- ☐ Smoke detectors working; pet alert sticker on door

POISON EMERGENCY

If you think your pet ate something toxic, call your veterinarian or an emergency clinic right away. You can also call the **ASPCA Animal Poison Control Center: (888) 426-4435** or **Pet Poison Helpline: (855) 764-7661** (consultation fees may apply). Do not induce vomiting unless a veterinarian tells you to.

First 24 Hours, First Week & First Month

Go slow. A calm, predictable start builds trust faster than a busy one.

First 24 hours

- ☐ Travel home in a secure carrier or crate; keep the ride quiet
- ☐ Dogs: go straight to the potty spot on leash before entering
- ☐ Cats: open the carrier in a small, quiet “home base” room with litter, food, water, hiding spot
- ☐ Let your pet explore at their own pace — no crowd of visitors
- ☐ Offer water and a small meal of their usual food
- ☐ Show the sleeping spot; keep bedtime quiet and dim
- ☐ Keep other pets separated for now
- ☐ Supervise children: calm voices, let the pet approach
- ☐ Dogs: potty trips every 1–2 hours while awake
- ☐ Check that ID tag / microchip info is up to date

First week

- ☐ Set a daily routine: meals, potty/litter, play, rest at the same times
- ☐ Vet visit within the first week (bring records)
- ☐ Begin gentle handling with treats: paws, ears, mouth
- ☐ Start simple training: name, sit, recall, litter habits
- ☐ Short, positive outings (dogs) or new rooms (cats)
- ☐ Slow introductions to resident pets (scent swaps first)
- ☐ Watch appetite, stool, urine, energy — call the vet if concerned
- ☐ Transition food gradually over 7–10 days if changing
- ☐ Register the microchip in your name
- ☐ Note what your pet loves (treats, toys, spots)

First month

- ☐ Complete any vaccine boosters your vet recommends
- ☐ Start parasite prevention as advised by your vet
- ☐ Enroll in a positive-reinforcement class (puppy/adult dog)
- ☐ Expand the home base (cats) as confidence grows
- ☐ Introduce grooming routines: brushing, nails, teeth
- ☐ Consider pet insurance while your pet is young/healthy
- ☐ Build alone-time practice gradually
- ☐ Celebrate: take a one-month photo!

Notes on how my pet is settling in

First Vet Visit Question List

Schedule a check-up within the first week. Bring this page and jot down answers.

What to bring

- ☐ All adoption/medical records
- ☐ A fresh stool sample (ask your vet)
- ☐ Food brand and amount
- ☐ List of questions + this page
- ☐ Leash/harness or secure carrier
- ☐ Small treats to make it fun

Visit details

Date _____

Clinic _____

Veterinarian _____

Weight today _____

Next visit _____

Question to ask	Answer / notes
Which vaccines does my pet need now, and when are boosters due?	
What parasite prevention do you recommend (fleas, ticks, heartworm, intestinal worms)?	
What should I feed, how much, and how often?	
What is a healthy weight and body shape for my pet?	
When should we spay/neuter (if not done)?	
Is the microchip working and registered?	
How should I care for teeth at home?	
What behavior or training issues should I watch for?	
Which signs mean I should call you right away?	
Where is the nearest 24-hour emergency clinic?	
Do you recommend pet insurance or a wellness plan?	
When is our next visit?	

Important: This guide is general education, not veterinary advice; consult your veterinarian about your own pet's health, diet, medications, and any symptoms that concern you.

Budget Planner Worksheet

Costs vary widely by region, species, size and health. Get local quotes and plan for the unexpected.

One-time setup costs

Item	Estimate	Actual
Adoption / purchase fee	\$	\$
Spay/neuter (if not included)	\$	\$
Initial vet exam & vaccines	\$	\$
Microchip	\$	\$
Crate / carrier	\$	\$
Bed & blankets	\$	\$
Bowls, collar, leash, ID tag	\$	\$
Litter boxes / gates	\$	\$
Toys, scratchers & chews	\$	\$
Grooming tools	\$	\$
Training class	\$	\$
Total setup	\$	\$

Monthly costs

Item	Estimate	Actual
Food	\$	\$
Treats & chews	\$	\$
Litter / poop bags	\$	\$
Parasite prevention	\$	\$
Pet insurance or wellness plan	\$	\$
Toys & replacement supplies	\$	\$
Grooming (professional)	\$	\$
Pet sitter / daycare / walker	\$	\$
Emergency fund savings	\$	\$
Monthly total	\$	\$
× 12 = yearly	\$	\$

Annual & emergency planning

Annual wellness exam & vaccines: \$ _____

Emergency fund goal: \$ _____

Dental cleaning (as recommended): \$ _____

Saved so far: \$ _____

Boarding / travel care: \$ _____

Monthly savings amount: \$ _____

TIP

Many owners set aside an emergency fund or choose pet insurance, since unexpected illnesses or injuries can cost far more than routine care. Compare deductibles, reimbursement rates and exclusions before choosing a plan.

Emergency Contacts Sheet

Fill this in, then post it on your fridge and snap a photo for your phone.

My pet Name _____ Species / breed _____ Age / birthday _____ Color & markings _____ Microchip # _____ Chip company _____ Allergies _____ Medications _____	Primary veterinarian Clinic _____ Vet name _____ Phone _____ Address _____ Hours _____ 24-hour emergency clinic Clinic _____ Phone _____ Address _____
Poison control ASPCA Animal Poison Control: (888) 426-4435 Pet Poison Helpline: (855) 764-7661 Consultation fees may apply.	Owners Name _____ Phone _____ Name _____ Phone _____

Backup caregivers

Name	Relationship	Phone	Has a key?	Knows routine?

Other helpful contacts

Service	Name	Phone / website
Pet sitter / walker		
Groomer		
Pet insurance (policy #)		
Local animal control / shelter		



Welcome to the family!

You've done the planning — now enjoy the cuddles, the play and the funny little moments. Remember: every new pet needs time to settle. Keep routines steady, be patient, and reach out to your veterinarian with any questions.

Be patient

Most pets need weeks, not days, to feel fully at home.

Be consistent

Same meal times, same rules, same kind voice.

Be prepared

Keep your emergency sheet filled in and visible.

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